CloudWorks Casino – Playtest Report

How did you find the difficulty? Was it too easy or too hard? Were there any inconsistencies with difficulty as you played?

Feedback

- Difficulty felt pretty well-balanced
- Certain areas with notes or keys gave trouble since interacting with the item could not be done without standing up
- Felt overly simple at times, especially at the very end

Reworks

- Made enemy pathing more complex, considering how sightlines and safe positions are affected
- Moved interactable elements to consistently be engaged with safely
- Decreased time on the escape sequence for a more tense and memorable gameplay moment
- Add checkpoints option for players who have more difficulty with the level

How easy did you find navigating through the level? Did you ever find yourself lost?

Feedback

- Certain elements like ladders did not stand out very much
- Some doors seemed interactable but were not
- Lights helped highlight important elements
- Navigation felt somewhat one-note

Reworks

- Use spotlights draw attention to important points of the level and guide the player
- Add collectibles near important areas like ladders so the player is more likely to notice them
- Make windows on doors black when they cannot be interacted with
- Remove interact box functionality for doors that are used as props
- Expand additional pathways and limit necessary backtracking by opening up other paths

Did you find the escape sequence time too long? Too short? Did the sequence feel tense? Did it feel out of place?

Feedback

- Section seemed too simple
- Time felt a little long for how straightforward the pathing is
- Adding nice variety to the level and made for a memorable moment

Reworks

- Decrease escape sequence time from two minutes to one minute
- Add more potential pathways in the final room of the escape sequence

Did you understand the narrative? Did the environments match the narrative?

Feedback

- Environments seemed to fit the story well
- Not much information was given on the correlation between the environment and the CloudWorks Corporation entity
- Some wording in the notes are awkward
- Little information on the world can be found from the environment

Reworks

- Added more distinct props that lend towards the intended story while allowing players to come to their own conclusions
- Made wording more natural in certain notes and considered the intentions of the writer and what information they might purposefully withhold
- Added more notes with small hints towards aspects of the story such as adding the name CloudWorks Corporation to titles of notes in the science lab

What was the most memorable part of the level for you?

Feedback

- Sneaking underneath the lasers in the science lab
- Walking down the stairs in the casino

Reworks

- Give other vantage points more visual interest that guide the player's eyes more
- Adjust prop placement and enemy pathing to encourage the player to make better use of their surroundings in unique ways
- Make rooms feel more notably distinct